

Wyoming Technology Licensing Inc. v. FCA US

A public complaint analysis reports that the matter concerns FCA's Hands-Free Active Driving Assist system and U.S. Patent Nos. 9,505,343 and 10,046,696. The reported technical issues include lane-change initiation through a turn-signal lever, sensor inputs, automatic vehicle control, statistical analysis, and machine-learning capability.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-24	U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Texas	3:26-cv-02839	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-27. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION

Wyoming Technology Licensing Inc. v. FCA US LLC

FORUM / DOCKET

U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Texas / 3:26-cv-02839

FILED / TYPE

2026-08-24 / patent infringement

PUBLIC DOCKET[Open docket](#)**VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD**

The public docket identifies Wyoming Technology Licensing Inc. as plaintiff, FCA US LLC as defendant, Civil Action No. 3:26-cv-02839, an August 24, 2026 filing date, the Northern District of Texas, and a 35 U.S.C. § 271 patent-infringement action. It describes Filing 1 as a complaint with three patent-in-suit exhibits and two chart exhibits, and identifies Joseph J. Zito, Benjamin C. Deming, and Rene A. Vazquez as counsel for the plaintiff. These are docket facts, not findings of infringement, validity, or damages.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Benjamin C. Deming - Outside counsel, DNL Zito. The current public docket identifies Deming as counsel for Wyoming Technology Licensing Inc. DNL Zito publicly lists his direct professional email and describes his patent-litigation practice. That makes him a plausible initial recipient for preliminary expert-search research; it does not establish purchasing authority.

bdeming@dnlzito.com - publicly printed in the [linked professional source](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

A public complaint analysis reports that the matter concerns FCA's Hands-Free Active Driving Assist system and U.S. Patent Nos. 9,505,343 and 10,046,696. The reported technical issues include lane-change initiation through a turn-signal lever, sensor inputs, automatic vehicle control, statistical analysis, and machine-learning capability.

Secondary-source limitation: The docket identifies three patent-in-suit exhibits while the public secondary analysis identifies two patents. The filed complaint, exhibits, intrinsic record, vehicle configurations, source code, and discovery must control any ultimate asserted-patent list, claim construction, or technical opinion. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. Patent No. 9,505,343](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 10,046,696](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Automatic-control state and lever operation

When FCA's lane-change assistance is used, does operation of the turn-signal lever turn an automatic control from an off state to an on state in the claimed sense, or merely trigger one event within an already-active driver-assistance system?

Potential evidence: Claim language, vehicle manuals, HMI requirements, ECU state-machine design, CAN traces, event logs, source code, and controlled vehicle tests.

02 Sensor-to-control path

Which cameras, radars, maps, controllers, and software components receive environmental data and determine whether to issue a steering or lane-change command?

Potential evidence: System architecture, sensor specifications, ADAS ECU software, interface-control documents, diagnostic traces, calibration records, and vehicle testing.

03 Statistical analysis versus rules-based control

Does the accused system perform the claimed statistical analysis on sensor data to determine a vehicle-control parameter, or use deterministic thresholds, rule logic, or a materially different method?

Potential evidence: Algorithms, model specifications, source code, calibration tables, design reviews, simulation inputs and outputs, test data, and engineering testimony.

04 Machine-learning capability and historical-data use

Does any relevant function use machine learning or historical data in the claimed sense, and if so, is it used to determine the asserted control parameter rather than for a separate design, training, or data-collection function?

Potential evidence: Training and deployment pipelines, model artifacts, embedded binaries, parameter-update logic, data-retention records, model cards, source code, and version histories.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Feature, vehicle, and version attribution

Which feature, model year, hardware configuration, and software release performs each alleged sensing, decision, signaling, or steering step?

Potential evidence: Feature matrices, VIN/build records, release notes, supplier specifications, service materials, test vehicles, and version-control evidence.

06 Driver role and safety gates

What driver confirmation, supervision, roadway conditions, and safety gates are required before a lane-change maneuver occurs, and do they affect the proposed mapping of automatic operation on behalf of the driver?

Potential evidence: HMI specifications, manuals, warning logic, operational-design-domain documents, safety analyses, test protocols, and recorded vehicle traces.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Philip Koopman, PhD

Associate Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering, Carnegie Mellon University

TECHNICAL FIT

Automotive functional safety, autonomous-vehicle testing, embedded-system safety, and run-time monitoring fit ADAS state, sensor, control, and safety-gate questions.

RELEVANT WORK

CMU describes more than 20 years of autonomous-vehicle-safety work, including stress testing and run-time monitoring; his public resume identifies authorship of the UL 4600 Guidebook.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

His public resume states that he has served as an expert witness in patent, automotive-liability, and economic-loss class-action matters.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Needs product-specific, funding, and conflict review for FCA/Stellantis systems.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | koopman@cmu.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Mohan M. Trivedi, PhD

Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering, University of California San Diego

TECHNICAL FIT

Computer vision, multimodal sensing, driver-intent prediction, and autonomous-driving systems fit vehicle sensing, lane-change evaluation, and driver/system interaction.

RELEVANT WORK

UC San Diego materials identify work on driver intent using multimodal sensory cues, autonomous driving, perception, motion prediction, and driver-state monitoring.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

No cited FCA-specific work or identified patent-testimony history.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | mtrivedi@ucsd.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Ragunathan (Raj) Rajkumar, PhD

George Westinghouse Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering, Carnegie Mellon University

TECHNICAL FIT

Connected and autonomous driving, automotive embedded real-time systems, control architecture, and driver/vehicle mode transitions fit the asserted issues.

RELEVANT WORK

CMU identifies him as co-director of the GM-CMU Connected and Autonomous Driving Collaborative Research Lab and director of the Real-Time and Multimedia Systems Lab.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

GM-CMU collaboration requires particular relationship and conflict diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | raj@ece.cmu.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Steven E. Shladover, PhD

Faculty and lead researcher, UC Berkeley Institute of Transportation Studies and PATH

TECHNICAL FIT

Vehicle-highway automation, cooperative adaptive cruise control, and automated-driving systems fit driving-assistance modes and control-system evidence.

RELEVANT WORK

Berkeley describes research in intelligent transportation systems, vehicle-highway automation, autonomous vehicles, and cooperative systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Best fit is automation and standards rather than embedded machine-learning implementation.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | steve@path.berkeley.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Henry X. Liu, PhD

Bruce D. Greenshields Collegiate Professor, University of Michigan; Director of UMTRI and Mcity

TECHNICAL FIT

Connected and automated-vehicle testing, modeling, control, and transportation AI fit vehicle control and test methodology.

RELEVANT WORK

Michigan identifies him as director of UMTRI, Mcity, and the Center for Connected and Automated Transportation, with work in automated-vehicle evaluation.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

No cited FCA-specific or turn-signal-feature analysis.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | henryliu@umich.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Matthew J. Barth, PhD

Distinguished Professor and Associate Dean, University of California Riverside

TECHNICAL FIT

Connected and automated vehicles, cooperative perception, navigation, and hardware-in-the-loop testing fit sensor, control, and evidence questions.

RELEVANT WORK

UCR identifies research in connected and automated vehicles, cooperative perception, advanced navigation, and real-vehicle testing.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Its documented focus is broader ITS and testbeds rather than a particular ADAS feature or claim.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | matthew.barth@ucr.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 John J. Leonard, PhD

Samuel C. Collins Professor of Mechanical and Ocean Engineering, MIT; Technical Advisor to Toyota Research Institute

TECHNICAL FIT

Autonomous-vehicle navigation, mapping, robotics, AI, and vehicle safety fit environmental perception and lane-change decision inputs.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT identifies work in navigation and mapping for autonomous robots and Toyota Research Institute technical-advisor work on vehicle safety.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Toyota relationship creates a clear screening issue; primary work is navigation/mapping rather than the exact ML limitation.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | jleonard@mit.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Jonathan P. How, PhD

Richard Cockburn Maclaurin Professor of Aeronautics and Astronautics, MIT

TECHNICAL FIT

Robust, adaptive, and model-predictive control, machine learning, motion planning, and autonomous navigation fit automatic-control logic and decision-making questions.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT identifies research interests in robust and adaptive control, model-predictive control, machine learning, and reinforcement learning.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Work spans aircraft, spacecraft, and ground autonomy; ADAS and testimony fit need case-specific review.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | jhow@mit.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Daniela Rus, PhD

Director of MIT CSAIL; Panasonic Professor of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science at MIT

TECHNICAL FIT

Robotics, AI, autonomy, uncertainty quantification, and reliable machine-learning driving systems fit machine-learning capability and automated decision logic.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT identifies Rus as CSAIL director and professor in AI/ML and robotics; MIT News reports work on reliability of machine-learning autonomous-driving systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Toyota-related research and broad AI portfolio require careful conflict and scope diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | rus@csail.mit.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Alexander Amini, PhD

Research Affiliate, MIT CSAIL; autonomy and safe-decision-making researcher

TECHNICAL FIT

Robust learning, confidence estimation, end-to-end control, and autonomous-vehicle control fit the alleged ML and sensor-to-control issues.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT CSAIL identifies work on end-to-end autonomous-system control, confidence of neural networks, inertial refinement, and Robust Learning for Autonomous Vehicles.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Research-affiliate status requires careful review of testimonial experience, methods, and conflicts.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | Amini@mit.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/texas/txndce/3%3A2026cv02839/425397>

Public professional email source: <https://dnlzito.com/>

Public technical context source: <https://ai-lab.exparte.com/case/dct/txnd/3%3A26-cv-02839/doc/analysis/1>

LIMITATIONS

The docket identifies three patent-in-suit exhibits while the public secondary analysis identifies two patents. The filed complaint, exhibits, intrinsic record, vehicle configurations, source code, and discovery must control any ultimate asserted-patent list, claim construction, or technical opinion.

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